

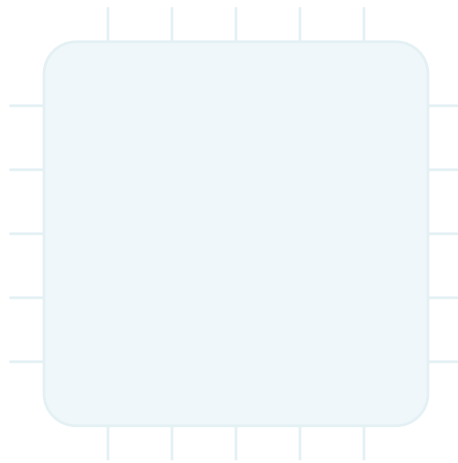


Better Prompts vs. Shortcut Prompts

Student Activity | AI Literacy Starter Kit

Student Activity

AI should help students think better, not think less.



What this resource helps students do

- Compare learning prompts and shortcut prompts
- Rewrite weak prompts into stronger learning prompts
- Reflect on responsibility and verification

Tennessee Standards Connection (Summary)

This resource may support Tennessee Computer Science Foundations standards when used as part of AI literacy instruction. See the full resource document for detailed standards connection.

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Student Directions

AI can help you learn, but only if you use it the right way. In this activity, you will compare prompts that avoid thinking with prompts that support learning.

Part 1: Sort the Prompts

Mark each prompt as L = Learning Support, S = Shortcut, or U = Unsure.

Part 2: Rewrite the Prompt

Shortcut prompt 1: _____

Better learning prompt 1: _____

Shortcut prompt 2: _____

Better learning prompt 2: _____

Shortcut prompt 3: _____

Better learning prompt 3: _____

Part 3: Reflection

Did the prompt help me learn?

Did the prompt keep me responsible for the work?

Would I be able to explain the result?

What should I verify?

Would my teacher consider this acceptable?



Detailed Tennessee Standards Connection

This resource may support the following Tennessee standards when used as part of AI literacy, computer science, programming, digital ethics, or cybersecurity instruction.

This activity directly supports standards when students evaluate AI use, revise prompts, verify outputs, and explain why a prompt supports or weakens learning.

Standards source: Tennessee Department of Education, Computer Science Foundations (C10H11), May 2023. Confirm final alignment against local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.

This resource may support the following Tennessee standards when used as part of AI literacy, digital ethics, computer science, or cybersecurity instruction:

- CSF 13.1 - Social, Legal, and Ethical Issues: Students identify responsibilities related to ethical technology use, academic integrity, copyright, privacy, and appropriate AI use.
- CSF 8.1 - Emerging Technologies: Students examine how emerging technologies influence society, school, work, and future readiness, using evidence and reflection.
- CSF 9.2 - Troubleshooting Process: Students use a structured process to identify a need, test or improve a response, verify the result, and document what they learned.

Cautious guidance: confirm final alignment against local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.